Proton Contacts for Business

Product Task: Sherry Bond, October 2026

Resources

The main source for visuals and additional info:

https://shez-deploys.github.io/pm-task/index.html

AI Transparency

This document was written by a human.

- All code was deployed to my github repo manually.
- Claude Opus 5.5 was used to generate the design system and translate my figma scratchpads, spreadsheets and additional writings into a website.
- All PII used is entirely fictional.
- Claude paid subscription with model training disabled
- The project will be removed/privated on my repo post interview.

1. Challenge & Strategy

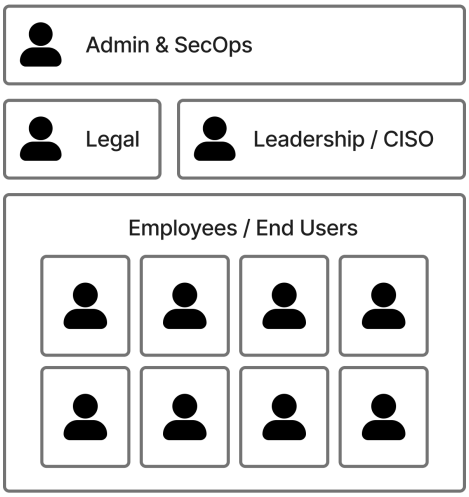
In this exercise, we will explore **how contacts can be essential in building a trust first solution across an entire business suite**. Contacts move from an address book to the context and trust layer behind every person shown in Proton, colleagues and outside contacts alike.

The challenge is composed of three components:

1. How can we utilise **Contacts** to connect the Proton Business Suite across applications and bring a more mature B2B solution to market.
2. How can we differentiate ourselves within an oligopoly?
3. How can we bring platform-wide intelligence without compromising privacy?

↗ OPTIONAL: DETAILS, ASSUMPTIONS ETC

Personas & Market



COMPANIES

SMB

More likely to use one solution as a suite, if directory and protection elevates through buying more Proton products, more likely to become the primary provider.

Core business metric
Cross-sell, potential additional cyber security budget.

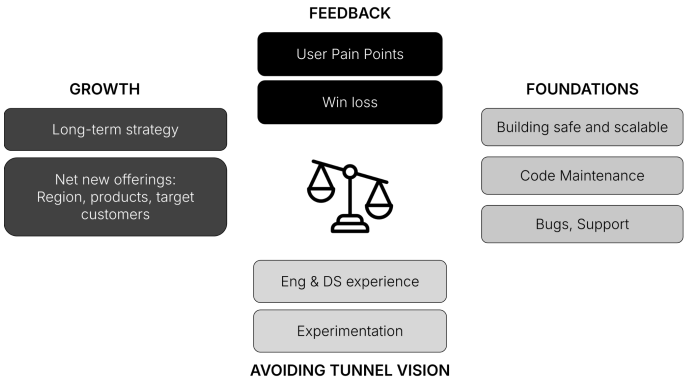
ENTERPRISE

Unlikely to fully transition to Proton for full suite across all users, assumption is that Proton is run alongside MS / Google.

Core business metric
Seat expansion, use cases

2. Backlog & Prioritisation

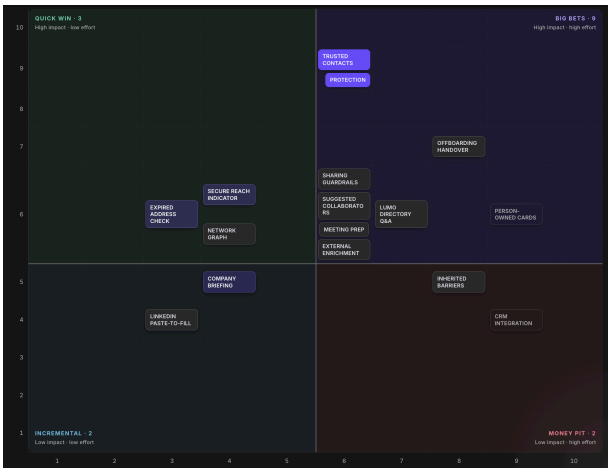
↗ ENLARGE IMAGE



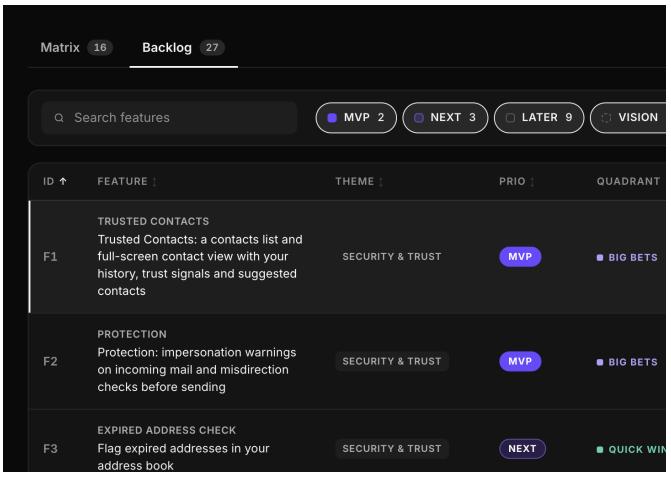
In a realistic scenario a blend of win-loss, analytics and customer discovery would contribute to us generating an understanding of hurdles for users, administrators and buyers. Once these are established, we weigh them against our strategic direction.

Based on the pain points I brainstormed a few potential candidates, using impact/effort to evaluate their impact in the challenge outlined.

↗ GO TO IMPACT MATRIX



↗ GO TO BACKLOG



Note on AI usage: *Full Backlog and Impact Effort sources can be seen in attached spreadsheet, AI was used to visualise thereafter:* *PM: Contacts Feature at Proton*

3. MVP, Mockups & Delivery

Prioritisation produced two features, of which we will focus on the first "**Trusted Contacts**". Both are built on the same thing: the contacts you already have, enriched on your device with your own history.

Additionally, this will unlock countless cross-functional features across the Proton suite, enabling us to build a reliable engine for our agents to be more precise and contextual.

NOW (MVP)	NEXT
1. TRUSTED CONTACTS	2. PROTECTION
A contacts list and a cross-suite contact view with your history, trust signals and suggested contacts	Warnings when the wrong person is involved: a sender posing as a contact, or an email about to reach the wrong person

[MVP] Project 1: Trusted Contacts

↗ TRUSTED CONTACTS: INTERACTIVE MOCKUP

Other workspaces know who to message, Proton knows who to trust.

Contacts stop being a list of names. Every person comes with your shared history and the signals that show whether they are who they claim to be.

PART	FUNCTIONALITY
Contacts list	Everyone with company, groups, last contact, history counts and trust status. Hover for a quick summary card.
Contact view	Opens full screen instead of a modal, with Overview, Notes, Email, Calendar, Files and Connections tabs
Trust signals	A checklist: domain verified, key verified, known since, consistent sender
Suggested contacts	People you write to often but haven't saved, ranked by confidence. Look-alike addresses are never suggested.
	Descoped items here

[NEXT] Project 2: Protection

↗ PROTECTION: INTERACTIVE MOCKUP

Not a full focus for this task, but a point on vision. The same contact data protects in both directions: incoming mail is checked against the people you already know, and outgoing mail against who you usually send this kind of email to.

PART	FUNCTIONALITY
Inbound: impersonation	Look-alike characters, near-miss domains, display-name spoofs, reply-to mismatches and payment requests from new senders
Outbound: misdirection	A recipient who looks like a contact but works at a different company, or who doesn't fit the thread, topic or attachment
Admin controls	Trusted domains and partner domains Warn or block for each check, inbound and outbound Organisation-wide reporting on warnings (counts only)

4. Metrics

Success Criteria

- **Employee:** knows who they're dealing with at a glance, in any app, without searching across Mail, Calendar and Drive.

- **Client-facing employee:** has the full history with a client or supplier in one place, and can tell a long-standing contact from a first-time sender.
- **Admin:** data protection built in, without additional SecOps load.

Metrics

METRIC	TARGET (ASSUMED)	MEASURE
Share of weekly active seats that open a contact card	**40% six months after launch**	**Counter on the device, aggregated per organisation**
Contact card opens per active seat per week	Rising week on week	Counter on the device
Apps that show the card	5 by general availability	Release tracking
Contacts with at least one trust signal	80%	Counter on the device
Suggested contacts accepted (contact created)	Over 30% of suggestions shown	Counter on the device
Time to answer "who is this and how do I know them?"	50% faster than today	Usability sessions

↗ MOCK ROADMAP

Conclusion

Ultimately, whilst contacts on its own are not revolutionary, it can be an essential thread through all services Proton provides. Delivering a secure, flexible network approach may lay important foundations in how we manage external directories and employee use cases, and lay important foundations for the protection of customer data.

The challenge of avoiding diversion when building out a large product suite is a critical one to master, requiring a great product team with a great skill for collaboration. I am looking forward to chatting with all of you.